

Chapter 12: The "Manager" (WordPress & CMS) - Guided Notes

Name: _____ Date: __ Class/Period: __

Essential Question:

How do Content Management Systems empower non-technical users to build, manage, and publish to dynamic websites without writing custom code?

PART 1: Welcome to the Manager's Office

1. What is a CMS?

- CMS stands for ____.
- A true CMS separates the _____ creation from the code structure and design.
- WordPress is built using the _____ programming language and stores your data in a _____ **Database** (the "Brain" that remembers everything you type).

2. The Great Confusion: .com vs .org

- **WordPress.com (The Rental):** A hosting company manages everything for you. It's easy, but you can't install many plugins without paying a high fee. You are living in their house by their rules.
- **WordPress.org (The Owner):** You download the free ____ - ____ software and install it on your own server. You have total freedom and own every line of code.

PART 2: The Dashboard & Architecture

3. The Manager's Quick Glossary:

- _____ : The private back-end mission control center.
- _____ : A folder of CSS and PHP that controls the "Look" or visual design. (The "Clothes").
- _____ : A "Mini-App" that gives the site new powers (e.g., adding a store).
- **Media Library:** The digital warehouse where all your uploaded photos and videos live.

4. The Manager's Dilemma: Posts vs. Pages

- _____: These are **Timely**. They are arranged in reverse-chronological order (newest on top) and rely heavily on Categories and Tags. (Example: News updates).
- _____: These are **Timeless**. They don't have a date and live in your navigation Menus. (Example: "About Us" or "Contact").

PART 3: Publishing & The Editor

5. The Block Editor (Gutenberg):

- The modern WordPress editor treats every paragraph, image, or video as its own movable _____.
- _____ **Image:** The main thumbnail people see when the post is shared on social media.
- **Revisions:** Automatically saved previous versions you can restore if you make a mistake.
- _____: Small pieces of code in brackets (e.g., `[gallery]`) that execute a larger plugin feature within a post.

PART 4: Professional Strategy & Security

6. User Roles: Security starts with permissions. The _____ has absolute total control over the site, while an *Author* can only publish their own posts.

7. The Maintenance Protocol (The Golden Rule): To stay secure, you must regularly update the core, themes, and plugins. **Before any update, you MUST perform a complete database and file _____.** **8. SEO & Findability:** Use the _____ settings to make URLs readable for humans and search engines (e.g., `/about-us` instead of `?p=123`).

9. The Danger of "No-Code" Builders: Builders like Wix or Squarespace are easy for beginners but result in ____: you do not own the code and cannot easily move your site to a new host.



CORNELL SUMMARY

Summary Prompt: In 3-4 complete sentences, explain the difference between a "Theme" and a "Plugin" using the smartphone analogy discussed in the chapter.